

Analysis of Mechanics

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Title: Kingdom Come Deliverance II

Released: 2025

Author: Warhorse (Deep Silver)

Primary Genre: Action role-playing, Open world

Secondary Genre: Adventure, first person, (survival, casual, stealth, horror, ...)

Style: Realistic, medieval, history accurate

Analysis

Kingdom Come Deliverance II is an Action role-playing open world game. The primary mechanics evolve around quest completion, combat, interaction with NPCs and the game world, exploration, and the gradual development of the main character. The players' choices influence the game world itself. These concepts are common for many Action role-playing games based in large open worlds. On top of this, the game uses several mini games and blends in various side genres to enhance gameplay, improve immersion, or break down repetitiveness.

The players complete a rich set of quests. The game could be praised for well designed quest lines, in both main and side quests. Although there are many quests and activities, they rarely feel repetitive. Some of the possible reasons for this include the overall diversity of the quests, rich story and well defined characters in both main and side quest lines, as well as strong engagement in exploration of the whole map and interaction with NPCs. Nice addition to interaction with NPCs is the ability to engage in quick dialogues, similar to games like *Red Dead Redemption II*.

One of the main mechanics of KCD II is, of course, combat. The game takes the player into many types of brawls and fights. These range from small fist fights, through ambushes, to large scale battles and castle sieges. The main character can use a large variety of historically accurate close and long range weapons. Close range weapons include swords, axes, pole arms and other. Long range weapons are bows, crossbows and early muskets. Each allows for a different play style.

For character development a system of statistics and skills is used. By engaging in different activities, the player improves different stats. For example, running might improve vitality. Engaging in activities as well as quest completion also give player skill points that can be spent to obtain different game changing perks.

As already stated at the beginning of this analysis, the game offers large set of mini games and activities. Some of these are potion making, blacksmithing, hunting, herb picking or tournaments. The game also allows the player to solve different situations in many ways. A stolen item from a bandit camp might be obtained by brute force (combat), persuasion (NPC interaction) or stealth (poison the food, steal the item during night), etc. From the point of view of secondary genres we could talk about stealth (as mentioned above), casual (mini games, ex. herb picking), survival (generally the whole game), horror (walking through Kuttenberg tunnels when ominous music plays) and many others.

In my opinion the developers found the ideal balance when it comes to mixing primary and secondary genres and game mechanics. The gameplay loop is not distracting, on the contrary, it is immersive. The mini games and activities aid the diversity of the game and minimize repetition. A good thing is also the fact that most mini games (or generally situations where other genres blend in, or that might feel repetitive) are not mandatory. For example the player does not need to repetitively spend time making swords if they do not want to.

As the last thing comes the style of the game, which I believe was perfectly chosen. The game takes place in medieval Bohemia and is deeply rooted in historical accuracy. Style of the graphics and UI together with a perfect musical score and sounds support the overall immersiveness of the gameplay by staying true to the setting of the game.